international troubles is practical and wise.'[7] Following a principle-based moralistic foreign policy helped India project itself as a leader of fellow developing former colonies, and helped India punch above its weight. It also tied in to India's goals of decolonization, anti-racialism and disarmament.

While non-alignment fulfilled a moral dimension of India's policy it did not provide India with the critical support needed when faced with war and conflict. During the 1962 India–China war, the non-aligned countries remained non-aligned and it was the West that really supported India, both with economic and military resources. As Mansingh states, the Non-Aligned Movement ended up becoming 'an aggregation of states with disparate interests' that had nothing in common except that they were former colonies. This led to a 'dynamics of group behaviour' that was not always in tune with India's needs and interests.[8] While Indian leaders sought global peace and nuclear disarmament, other countries had their own set of problems.

Non-alignment also clashed with the reality of living in a world where a country could only defend itself with economic and military power. India's policy of non-alignment posed problems in achieving these goals. Non-alignment was more anti-Western capitalism and imperialism than it was against Soviet communism. Some analysts ascribe that to Nehru's sympathy towards Soviet socialism and scepticism and cynicism towards American capitalism. Others blame America's pro-Pakistan policy and Soviet support especially their veto on the Kashmir issue in the Security Council. The balancing act sought was how to receive economic and military aid from both blocs while not becoming too dependent on either.

With the end of the cold war and the break-up of the Soviet Union, India has built closer ties with the United States. Russia no longer occupies the position it did. Still the Indian elite remains suspicious and sceptical of American intentions. Knee-jerk criticism of American foreign policy and